

## THE MORNING AFTER by pete lightner

Wichita has had almost every change possible on a ball club this year except a new manager. With two new managers in the majors in less than ten days, and three in the season far from over, the nation's editors are asking: What price baseball brains?

Washington changed first, then Pittsburgh and Kaysee. In the long run, nothing will be accomplished except to satisfy the fans who always want to make some one the goat for a losing team. On the other hand, isn't a winning manager always heralded as a mastermind who molds a great team out of a bunch of hired hands?

The Cleveland Plain Dealer on its editorial page has grown cynical and suggests: "Why not TWO managers? This would be especially constructive as far as the club owner is concerned, since he could really show the fans he was trying to get the club out of seventh or eighth place by firing BOTH managers."

The Louisville Courier-Journal, which should know all about losing clubs, reminds that Lou Boudreau was a boy wonder manager

when he had himself to play shortstop so brilliantly and pitchers like Boo Feller to set strike-out marks. It then waxes profound by saying:

"The binomial theorem is no substitute for the incalculable luck of stumbling upon a Stan Musial or a Mickey Mantle to whack it over the fence and bring the runs in. And boos from the stands when the home athletes don't produce are as sure a source of high mortality among baseball managers as the Asiatic cholera."

And it winds up with this, which is probably for Senator Sorghum to pursue:

"Which leads up to suggest that baseball is making out a poor case for the proposition that it is a sport and a tradition to be indulged rather than a business to be regulated."

### Fritzie Gets a Plug

The Sporting News this week has a feature story about a young Wichita. Fritzie Brickell, who has robbed the Wichita Braves of a half hundred assorted potential base hits this season. His work has been a feature of the Wichita-Denver games and he was especially brilliant when Wichita played an unfortunate series in the Mile High city in June.



BRICKELL

Frank Haraway, often a visitor here as Denver Post reporter, authors the yarn and says in part:

"Fritz Brickell, Denver's little bundle of shortstop dynamite, is a leading nominee for the title of most underrated player in the American Association. Maybe it's because the five-foot, six-inch, 150-pounder is so small he's hard to see. Maybe it's because he's so quiet and unassuming. Or maybe it's because he's not particularly fast as foot like most little guys in sports are expected to be. But the records show Fritz to be doing quite a job for the Bears. In fact, he is one of the solid favorites of Denver fans."

Haraway quotes Manager Ralph Houk about Brickell's ability to come in fast and get the slow one, the hardest play for a shortstop to make. Houk says Fritzie can make the double play from the third base side as well as any major league shortstop. "His power

is to all fields and he has amazing power for a little fellow," the boss stated.

The story also quoted Andy Cohen of Indianapolis as saying Fritzie is a great deal improved over last year in the Southern, and that he was good then. "I haven't seen him do anything wrong, he does a lot right, and he's getting better," Cohen told it.

The Denver scribe admits that Brickell hasn't made fans forget Tony Kubek (Yanks) but that "he's filling the gap well, both in the field and at the plate, where he is hitting .290." He also reminds that Fritzie's dad, Fred was a big league outfielder with Pittsburgh for several years.

He might have added that the sale of the young high school football star (Brickell) was the biggest financial coup Frank Isbell ever made. It netted him \$15,000 in real money, which would buy a lot in those days of 1927.

It also caused Isbell to go in for young talent, something which later made him a bit unpopular, as it costs pennants. Veteran stars, such as Berger, Beck and Butler had provided Wichita with the winners, consistently.

Also, the all time high mark for Western League ball at old Island Park was only 108,000, which was a whale of a lot in those days when only 4,000 could be crowded into stands and bleachers, and there was NO night ball, putting overwhelming importance on Sunday play. Thus a Sunday rainout might mean the difference between a profit and loss for the baseball year.

